

Rob Dobson

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SUMMARY

Senior digital leader with 27 years' experience driving strategic digital initiatives, technological innovation, and measurable business outcomes. Highlights include head of design and development for the world's first digital bank in 1999 and proven success delivering significant sales growth and award-winning digital projects for many clients within my own digital agency, Northern Comfort, for the past 15 years. I've also had senior freelance roles within various global marketing agencies including DigitasLBI and The Chase.

Highly skilled in rapidly diagnosing complex digital issues, identifying practical technology solutions and significantly improving digital performance through Conversion Rate Optimisation (CRO). Known for clear communication, effective stakeholder management, and aligning digital initiatives directly with commercial objectives to deliver solid results.

KEY COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Digital Leadership – Quickly identifying digital challenges and opportunities to develop clear, actionable strategies.
 - Conversion Rate Optimisation (CRO) – Improving digital performance by identifying and implementing measurable, high-impact website and marketing improvements and SEO.
 - Clear Communication & Stakeholder Management – Translating complex digital concepts into straightforward plans, securing buy-in from senior stakeholders and internal teams.
 - Commercially-Focused Digital Solutions – Ensuring digital initiatives directly support measurable business goals and commercial success.
 - Agency and Vendor Management – Evaluating, briefing, and managing external partners to ensure alignment, cost efficiency, and performance.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Northern Comfort (northerncomfort.co.uk)
Founder

January 2011 - Present

I founded Northern Comfort as a digital agency in 2011 and grew the business to eight people plus freelancers. In that time we worked with multinational, billion-dollar companies such as Uncle.co.uk, RealStar, DeGruyter, Birkhauser, CEU, Morley College, L&Q; plus agencies DigitasLBI and The Chase.

I acted as head of creative, UX, client manager, and coder during this time, across multiple clients, industries, contracts and countries, servicing clients in the US, Germany, Europe and the UK.

We created award-winning digital strategies and websites, most recently winning The Heist Gold award 2024 for work with Morley College. I am well-versed in creating digital and marketing strategies with buy-in at C-Suite level, and have experience at virtually every discipline. Most recently I've been using AI for 3+ years.

I've increased conversion rates on many websites; through our five-year relationship with Uncle we redesigned, rebuilt and customised their website, creating conversion rate increases of 225%, selling out all buildings in their portfolio. Commonly I created conversion rate increases of 30% upwards. I've used a multitude of CRO products in this time, alongside both quant and qual research.

I also wrote a sell-out book on CRO and have been a speaker on CRO at D2C Industry Events such as Bread and Jam.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONT'D)

Manchester Airport Group

September 2009 - January 2011

Head of Intranet

Redeveloped and re-launched the MAG intranet, gaining support and buy-in across a very wide range of stakeholders up to C-Suite level. Increasing usage and time spent on the site many times over. I also produced and design the in-house magazine, and liaised and managed many external business providers.

Co-operative Group/smile.co.uk

June 1999 - September 2009

Head of Intranet

At smile.co.uk I was responsible for the Design and Development of the website; the world's first fully functional Internet Bank. I designed and created the UX for the full site, including all banking screens across all devices, a structure and design which was then copied for the Co-op Bank site. I liaised directly with the CEO and other Directors in this role, and created a multi-award winning, innovative website.

At the Co-op Group I redeveloped and re-launched the Coop intranet, gaining support and buy-in across a very wide range of stakeholders up to C-Suite level. Managed a team of two designer and coders, I also was responsible for the production of the MAG Annual reports.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Science

Physics

Manchester University

PGCE (GCSE Science)

Manchester Met

MiniMBA Marketing

Mark Ritson/Marketing
Week